

White Batteries

Direct and Indirect

By C.G.S.Narayanan

A white battery ,more often than not, is used as a strategic device rather than as a central idea. Sometimes problems present an admixture of both. The three two-movers presented in this article show battery play as central idea. The first problem below by the Russian maestro exhibits direct battery mates. The B+R battery is controlled by the BBa2 and the control of this bishop cannot be shut off by Rd5 and so the key 1.Ng6 facilitates this after the square g2 is blocked. The variation 1...Ng2 2.Rd5 is a White interference and 1...Nc4+ 2 Re5 a cross-check. In addition to these there are three more defences allowing mates by the battery

L.I.Loshinski

2 prize, Olympic Ty 1964



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Ng6! (2.Nf4)

1...Nc4+ 2.Re5; 1..Ng2 2.Rd5

1...g2 2.Rf3; 1...d5 2.Rf2

1...Rc4 2.Rf4; 1...h1Q 2.Qxh1

Two by-play variations round off this attractive work which is notable mainly for the extraordinary economy of white force. The battery mates in the above are all direct since the rear piece is aimed straight at the black king. If the rear piece is

aimed instead at a black king flight square, potential or actual, we have an indirect battery.

V.Chepizny

Ist prize, The Problemist 1982/I



Mate in two moves

The indirect battery created by the **key 1.Ne4!** (2.Nxc2) is aimed at e3 the flight granted by the key. The two direct batteries are Qd7+Nd4 and Ra3+Bb3.. 1..Ke3+ 2.Bc4 1...Rxe4 2.Be6; 1...cxd4 2.Bd5 are the main variations. 1...Nxf7 2.Bxf7; 1...Rxf5 2.Nxf5; 1...Bc4 2.Bxc2; 1...Nb8 2.Nxc5 1...Bf2 2.Bxf2

The problem for solving below adds changed battery mates.

R.E.Burger

Ist prize, US Problem Bulletin 1984



Mate in two mates

Solutions to problems for solving in the article: Excelsior, the lone warrior' (Wornaid Robert) **1.d4+** Kxd6 2. dxc5+ Kc6 3.cxb6+ bxc4 4.bxa7... 5.axb8Q mate (W.A.Shinkman) **1.d4** Ke6! **1.d3** Ke6 2.d4 Ke7 3.d5 Kf8 4.d6 Kg8 5.d7 Kf8 (3...Kd8 4.d6 Kc8 5.d7+ Kd8 6.Bf6

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